



CONSENT FORM

Project: **inSITE** | **Understanding the Social Determinants of Youth Suicide and Self-Harm in England**

Part 1 – to give you first thoughts about the project

Introduction

We would like you to help us with our research study. The following few pages will provide you with further information about the project, so that you can decide if you would like to take part in this research.

Please take the time to read this information carefully. You may ask questions about anything you do not understand or want to know more about.

It is up to you if you want to take part in this study. If you do not want to take part, you do not have to. If you begin participating, you can also stop at any time.

Why am I being asked to take part in this study?

Suicide and self-harm can be influenced by the broader social, political, economic and environmental factors around us, also known as social determinants. We want to understand the interaction between social determinants and individual risk factors (e.g., gender identity, mental illness, family history of suicide) and how this interplay impacts self-harm, suicide and suicidal behaviour among young people.

To help us answer this question, we would like to hear the views of young people (16-25) with lived or living experience of self-harm and/or suicidal thoughts and behaviours (e.g. attempted suicide). You have been identified as a young person with lived or living experience of self-harm and/or suicidal behaviour, and through this information sheet, we would like to invite you to take part in this study.

Why are we doing this research?

Suicide is among the leading causes of death among young people worldwide; thus, identifying and understanding the leading factors among young people is crucial. We know that there are numerous factors that drive but also protect against suicide and self-harm among the general population. What is less known is whether this is the case for young people. We do not know how and in what contexts social determinants drive or protect against suicide and self-harm, and how they interact with individual factors among young people.

We are a team of researchers at the University of Birmingham, and we want to help inform the development of evidence-based interventions and policies that can address social inequalities and prevent youth suicide at a population level.

To do this, we are recruiting young people from youth advocacy/advisory organisations, from the community, or online, to participate in semi-structured interviews that are designed to encourage conversations around the broad impact of social determinants on your lived or living experience of self-harm and/or suicidal thoughts or behaviours. You do not need to have a complete understanding of how social determinants influence your mental health, as we are also interested in your concerns.

Do I have to take part?

No. It is entirely up to you. If you do decide to take part:

- You will be asked to sign a form to say that you agree to take part (consent form).
- You will be given this information leaflet and a copy of your signed consent form to keep.
- You will be invited to a video briefing session with the researcher to discuss the interview, create a safety plan with you, and discuss any concerns/potential triggers in relation to the interview topic.

You are free to stop taking part at any time during the research without giving a reason. If you decide to stop, this will not affect you or your circumstances in any way.

What will happen if I take part?

Should you be interested, please contact Adam at a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk. A copy of this information leaflet will be sent, and you will have the opportunity to ask them any questions you may have. You can have up to 48 hours to consider taking part, if you need longer, you can discuss this with the research team. If you are happy to take part, you will be asked to sign a consent form.

The research team invites you to take part in one online interview lasting approximately 45 minutes to 1-hour, with breaks if needed. The interviews will take place at the University of Birmingham or online via Zoom or Microsoft Teams and will be facilitated by our research team.

Before the interview, we will ask you to complete a short questionnaire about you (age, gender, ethnicity, occupational status). We will also invite you to a briefing session with the researcher to discuss the interview, complete your safety plan with you, and discuss any concerns/potential triggers in relation to the interview topics.

During the interview, we will work together to understand your concerns and how broader social determinants interact with individual factors.

Will I receive any financial reimbursements for taking part?

You will be reimbursed £20 for your time. This will be in the form of a bank transfer or voucher at the researcher's discretion. If travelling to the University of Birmingham by public transport, travel costs will be covered up to £10.

Will the study help me?

We cannot guarantee or promise that you will receive any direct benefits from taking part in this project. The project has the potential to inform the development of evidence-based interventions and policies that can address social inequalities and prevent youth suicide at a population level.

What are the possible disadvantages and risks?

We do not anticipate any harm from taking part in the interview. We will not ask questions about your history of suicidal thoughts (i.e., thinking about suicide) or self-harm. However, the interviews will discuss suicide and self-harm, which some people find upsetting. You might feel upset or triggered when taking part in the interviews. We therefore encourage you to make sure you are feeling okay when you take part in the interviews (e.g., feel free to postpone it if you have had a bad day or are feeling very upset). You can take a break from the interviews at any time and/or stop participating in the study altogether.

Before the interviews, we will invite you to a short briefing session with the researcher. In this session, you can share with us the details of your GP and/or support person (if relevant) so we can contact them on your behalf if you would like us to. We will also invite you to share with us any concerns/triggers you may have in relation to the topic of the interviews and share the strategies you use when you are feeling upset (e.g., a particular mindfulness exercise). If we are worried about you during the interviews, we will offer to help you use the strategy in your safety plan that can help when you are feeling upset and/or call your GP or support person. The only time that we will break confidentiality (by phoning the emergency services, your support person/parent/guardian) is if we believe you are at immediate risk, and we will tell you if we do this. Following each interview, you will be offered a debrief meeting with a member of our research team. You will also be able to speak to your youth advisory co-ordinator for support should this be applicable to you. We will email you a debrief sheet regardless of whether you decide to have a debrief meeting or not. This contains information about the study, signposting information and contact information for suicide prevention helplines.

The interviews are for the purpose of research, and the researchers are not trained mental health professionals. Therefore, it is important that if you are feeling very upset or suicidal that you talk to an adult who you trust, contact your GP, and/or consider contacting one of the following confidential online and/or telephone counselling services:

PAPYRUS HOPELINE UK:	Childline:	Samaritans:
0300 102 2470	0800 1111	116 123
Text HOPE to 88247 pat@papyrus-uk.org	https://www.childline.org.uk/get-support/contacting-childline/	
Age range: Under the age of 35	Age range: Under the age of 19	Age range: None

What happens when the research study stops?

We will collect all the information together and prepare recommendations that can be used by researchers and policymakers to address social inequalities and prevent youth suicide at a population level.

Contact for further information

If you would like any further information about this study, you could contact:

Name: Adam Chen

Role: Researcher

Email: a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk

Phone: [tbc]

Thank you for reading so far - if you are still interested, please go to Part 2:

Part 2 - more detail – information you need to know if you still want to take part.

What will happen if I don't want to do the research anymore?

That is absolutely fine. Even if you decide to take part now, you can still change your mind at a later stage. Please note that if you choose to stop participating, we will keep all data that has been collected up until that point. Withdrawing from the research will not affect you or have any negative consequences on any of your circumstances.

What if something goes wrong?

If you have a concern about any aspect of this study, you should ask to speak to the researchers who will do their best to answer your questions. The researcher responsible for this project is: Adam Chen a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk. Or you can contact the University of Birmingham's Sponsor Representative via researchgovernance@contacts.bham.ac.uk. In the event that something does go wrong, and you are harmed during the research, and this is due to someone's negligence then you may have grounds for a legal action for compensation against The University of Birmingham but you may have to pay your legal costs.

How will we use information about you?

We will need to use information from you for this research project. This information will include:

- Your name
- Initials
- Demographic details (age, gender, ethnicity, occupational status)
- Contact Details

People will use this information to do the research to make sure that the research is being done properly. People who do not need to know who you are will not be able to see your name or contact details. Your data will have a code number instead. We will keep all information about you safe and secure. Once we have finished the study, we will keep some of the data so we can check the results. We will write our reports in a way that no-one can work out that you took part in the study.

What are your choices about how your information is used?

You can stop being part of the study at any time, without giving a reason. We will keep any data already provided if you choose to stop participating at any time.

Where can you find out more about how your information is used?

You can find out more about how we use your information by contacting the principal researcher for this study, Adam Chen a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk; and/or The University of Birmingham's Data Protection Officer, dataprotection@contacts.bham.ac.uk

What will happen to the results of this study?

When the study has finished, we will present our findings to young people, family members/carers, and doctors and researchers; and we will share the results via academic publication. You and the information we collected about you will not be identifiable in any report or publication. You will be able to say whether you would like the study results to be emailed directly to you.

Who is organising and funding this project?

This study is funded by the Economic and Social Research Council and insured by the University of Birmingham.

Who has checked the study?

All research in the University of Birmingham is looked at by an independent group of people, called a Research Ethics Committee, to protect your interests. This study has been reviewed and given favourable opinion by The University of Birmingham Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics Ethical Review Committee.

How can I find out more about this research?

If you would like any more information before deciding whether to participate, please contact the researcher. The researcher responsible for this project is: Adam Chen a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk

Thank you for taking the time to read this – please ask any questions if you need to.